NEXT CHAPTER @ SMITH PUBLIC LIBRARY

Grammar & Mechanics

Session 8: Reasoning Through Language Arts begins

Monday, November 9 • 5:30 PM • Multipurpose Room

Tonight's Plan

1	Welcome and Math checkpoint debrief	10 min
2	Why grammar matters on the GED	10 min
3	Sentences: fragments and run-ons	30 min
4	Commas: four rules	25 min
5	Apostrophes and look-alike words	20 min
6	Verbs that agree, then fix a paragraph together	15 min
7	Wrap-up and what's next	10 min

Quick Look Back: The Math Checkpoint

WELCOME

You sat down and finished a real, full-length GED practice test.

That takes stamina. Most people never try it.

Your score report shows your color and the skills to work on.

Math stays on the calendar. Thursday office hours are open for math questions.

Green? Tell Michelle and we will schedule your real Math test.

Yellow or red? That is a starting point, not a verdict.

You can retest at the Final Checkpoint on May 3.

Tonight we turn the page to Reading and Writing.

Why Grammar Matters on the GED



Editing Questions

Many RLA questions ask you to fix a sentence or choose the best word. That is grammar, tested directly.

Question formats: drop-down and multiple choice



Your Essay Score

The Extended Response is scored partly on clear, correct writing, so conventions count there too.

Clear sentences earn points



Real Life

Emails, job applications, and notes to your kids' school all go better with clean sentences.

Same skills, every day

The Heart of a Sentence: Who + Does What

SUBJECT

Who or what the sentence is about

The dog

VERB

What the subject does or is

barked

COMPLETE THOUGHT

It makes sense all by itself

at the mail carrier.

The dog barked at the mail carrier.

A full sentence needs all three. Miss one and you have a fragment.

Fragments: Something Is Missing

FRAGMENTS

Because the library was closed. Fragment: the thought is unfinished	Because the library was closed, we studied at home. Fixed: added the missing half
Running down the street every morning. Fragment: no real verb or subject	She runs down the street every morning. Fixed: subject + verb
The tall man in the blue jacket. Fragment: who did what?	The tall man in the blue jacket waved. Fixed: added a verb

Run-Ons and Comma Splices: Too Much

RUN-ONS

I finished my homework I went to bed.

Run-on: two sentences, no break

I finished my homework. I went to bed.

Fixed: a period

She likes tea, he prefers coffee.

Comma splice: a comma cannot do the job alone

She likes tea, but he prefers coffee.

Fixed: comma + joining word

We waited for the bus, it never came.

Comma splice

We waited for the bus; it never came.

Fixed: a semicolon

Three Ways to Fix It



Period

Split it into two sentences.

I was tired. I went home.



Comma + Joining Word

for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so

I was tired, so I went home.



Semicolon

Joins two full sentences that are closely related. No joining word.

I was tired; I went home.

Your Turn: Fix These Sentences

GUIDED PRACTICE

1. Because the library was closed. (Fix the fragment.)

2. I finished my homework I went to bed. (Fix the run-on.)

3. She likes tea, he prefers coffee. (Fix the comma splice.)

4. Running down the street every morning. (Fix the fragment.)

5. We waited for the bus, it never came. (Fix it with a joining word.)

Let's Check Your Answers

1. Because the library was closed, we studied at home.

2. I finished my homework. I went to bed. (or add “and”)

3. She likes tea, but he prefers coffee.

4. She runs down the street every morning. (add a subject)

5. We waited for the bus, but it never came.

Real-Life Fix: A Note to the Landlord

WORKED EXAMPLE

BEFORE

Dear Ms. Lopez, I am writing about the heater it has not worked since Monday, my kids are cold. Please send someone soon.

AFTER

Dear Ms. Lopez, I am writing about the heater. It has not worked since Monday, and my kids are cold. Please send someone soon.

Two fixes: a period (run-on) and a comma + and (comma splice). Now she can read it without stumbling.

Commas: Four Rules to Remember

1	**In a list**	Apples, bananas, and grapes.
2	**After an opener**	After the meeting, we went to lunch.
3	**Before a joining word**	I wanted to go, but it started to rain.
4	**Around extra information**	My sister, who lives in Dallas, is a nurse.

The Tricky One: Extra Information

RULE 4

If you can remove it and the sentence still makes sense, it is extra.

Put commas on both sides.

My sister, who lives in Dallas, is a nurse.

Remove it: My sister is a nurse. Still works. Extra, so commas.

The student who finished first won the prize.

Remove it and you lose which student. Needed, so no commas.

Your Turn: Add the Commas

GUIDED PRACTICE

1. We bought apples bananas and grapes.

2. After the meeting we went to lunch.

3. I wanted to go but it started to rain.

4. My sister who lives in Dallas is a nurse.

5. However the test was shorter than expected.

Let's Check Your Answers

1. We bought apples, bananas, and grapes.

2. After the meeting, we went to lunch.

3. I wanted to go, but it started to rain.

4. My sister, who lives in Dallas, is a nurse.

5. However, the test was shorter than expected.

Apostrophes Do Two Jobs



Missing Letters

it's = it is
they're = they are
don't = do not

A contraction squeezes two words into one.



Ownership

Maria's book
the dog's tail
the children's toys

Add apostrophe + s to show who owns it.



Never for Plurals

three dogs
four books
many students

A plain plural is just an s. No apostrophe.

Look-Alike Words

MEMORIZE THESE

its / it's	its = belongs to it • it's = it is
their / there / they're	their = belongs to them • there = a place • they're = they are
your / you're	your = belongs to you • you're = you are

The test: say it as “it is” or “you are.” If that fits, use the apostrophe.

Your Turn: Apostrophes and Look-Alikes

GUIDED PRACTICE

1. The dog wagged (its / it's) tail.

2. (Its / It's) going to rain today.

3. (You're / Your) going to do great.

4. The book belongs to Maria. Write it as ___ book.

5. There are three (dog's / dogs) in the park.

Let's Check Your Answers

1. its (ownership)

2. It's (it is going to rain)

3. You're (you are going to do great)

4. Maria's book

5. dogs (a plain plural has no apostrophe)

Make the Verb Match the Subject

SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

One subject takes is or has. Many subjects take are or have.

The box of pencils is on the desk.

Subject is box. Skip the words in between.

My brother and his friends play soccer.

Joined with “and” means plural.

Each of the students has a book.

Each, everyone, and someone are singular.

Your Turn: Pick the Right Verb

GUIDED PRACTICE

1. The box of pencils (is / are) on the desk.

2. My brother and his friends (plays / play) soccer.

3. Each of the students (has / have) a book.

4. There (is / are) three chairs in the room.

Let's Check Your Answers

1. is (the subject is box)

2. play (brother AND friends = plural)

3. has (each is singular)

4. are (the subject, chairs, comes after the verb)

Fix This Paragraph Together

CLASS ACTIVITY

Last week our class visited the library we learned how to use the computers. Its a great place to study and everyone is friendly. My friend Carlos who works nights says there open until 9. You should come with us next time

There are 6 fixes hiding here. Can you find them? (run-on • its • comma + and • extra info • there/they're • missing period)

Fixed Paragraph

ANSWER

Last week our class visited the library. We learned how to use the computers. It's a great place to study, and everyone is friendly. My friend Carlos, who works nights, says they're open until 9. You should come with us next time.

Tip: read it out loud. Your ear catches things your eyes skip.

Before You Go

1. Take-home practice is on the website.

21 questions in the GED formats. Find it on the Session 8 row.

2. The cheat sheet has every rule from tonight.

Keep it by your bed or on the fridge.

3. Extra Help handout (English and Spanish).

Friendly warm-ups if grammar still feels fuzzy.

4. Next Monday: Reading Comprehension.

We will practice finding the main idea. Bring your questions to Thursday office hours.

Good Writing Is a Skill, Not a Talent.

You fixed real sentences tonight. Keep going.